



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Judah Christian Academy
School Website: <https://judahchristianacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Judah Christian Academy NC 28164 presents a distinct Christian school identity based in Stanley, NC. Public-facing materials emphasize faith-based formation, community, and enrollment rather than a classical curriculum or classical pedagogy. This yields a nuanced result: the school demonstrates partial alignment with classical education concepts (notably in its religious/theological orientation and a formation-focused purpose), but it lacks explicit Great Books, liberal arts infrastructure, Socratic pedagogy, and the other hallmarks described in the classical rubric.

Overall classification: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical orientation is evident through explicit Christian framing and a formal Statement of Faith, which aligns with the religious underpinning of some classical models. Evidence: site identifies Judah Christian Academy as a Christian School and references a Statement of Faith. - The school's stated purpose centers on formation and impact on students and community, but the public materials do not demonstrate explicit classical aims such as virtue-centered formation with Great Books, Trivium pedagogy, or Great Conversation. Evidence: "formation" language and community emphasis are present, not explicit classical cueing. - There is little to no explicit documentation of classical curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; history as liberal study; etc.), nor of classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholé, rhetoric training). Evidence: the public content is largely admissions, news, and general faith-based messaging, with no clear Great Books or Trivium signals. - The knowledge-base lexicon confirms that classical education signals include a robust set of positive keywords (truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, etc.) and negative signals (relativism, project-based-only, etc.). The Judah site shows some religious signaling but lacks the explicit classical signals cited in the lexicon. This creates partial alignment rather than full classical alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Note: For each category, the analysis below uses keyword evidence from Judah Christian Academy's public materials and compares with the Positive/Negative keyword indicators from the classical-school lexicon. Positive keyword presence is counted where explicit terms or unambiguous equivalents appear on the site; negative keyword signals are counted if explicit negative terms from the lexicon are evident.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The site explicitly identifies Judah Christian Academy as a Christian School in Stanley, NC. This signals a religious/metaphysical orientation consistent with some classical foundations. - A dedicated Statement of Faith page exists, indicating theological framing and doctrinal grounding.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (direct/clear): Christian identity; Statement of Faith (implies theology/creed). These map loosely to the lexicon's categories (theology, creed). - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no signaling of relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral stances in the visible content).

Why this rating - The presence of explicit Christian identity and a Statement of Faith signals a religiously grounded metaphysical frame, which aligns with some elements of classical formation. However, there is no explicit articulation of transcendentals in classroom practice, liturgical structure, or communal liturgy within the public materials. Therefore, the foundation is present but not developed to the full classical depth, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation and impact on the community and students ("making an impact on the community and the hearts of each student"). This hints at formation-oriented aims rather than job-readiness alone.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (conceptually): formation/formation of character (via "hearts" language). While not the exact lexicon term "formation," the intention mirrors the classical aim of forming virtue and character. - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public messaging (no strong emphasis on workforce-readiness, 21st-century skills, or other modernist utilitarian aims in the visible text).

Why this rating - The school signals a formation-oriented goal aligned with the classical aim of human flourishing and virtue; however, it does not explicitly articulate the classical telos as "truth, goodness, and beauty" or mention Great Books, paideia, or liberal-arts formation. The result is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public site content shows general information about admissions, enrollment, and faith, but no explicit mention of liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, or Great Conversation. An "Academics" page exists, but the visible text does not reveal classical curricular components.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: None clearly evident (no explicit citations of liberal arts, trivium, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin/Greek, or Great Conversation). - Negative keywords present: None explicitly stated in the public materials about curriculum; however, absence of classical-curriculum terms is a key signal for NOT CLASSICAL positioning.

Why this rating - The absence of documented classical curriculum elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, etc.) strongly points to NOT CLASSICAL in the curriculum category. The presence of a general faith-based orientation without detailed classical content reduces the alignment.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials show no explicit reference to Socratic seminars, scholé days, memory work, chanting, or rhetoric training. The site largely centers on admissions, faith statements, and school updates.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: None clearly evident (no Socratic seminars, narration, or chanting terms present in the visible text). - Negative keywords present: None explicitly stated, but the lack of classical pedagogy signals implies not meeting the pedagogy criterion.

Why this rating - Without explicit evidence of classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue, memory work, or scholé-based instruction), the pedagogy category does not align with classical standards. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials do not describe a “living curriculum,” a “portrait of a teacher,” or a “faculty as mentors” framework. The content is focused on admissions, faith, and community messaging rather than teacher-type descriptions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: None explicitly stated (e.g., living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial faculty). - Negative keywords present: None explicit; lack of classical faculty descriptors indicates NOT CLASSICAL for this dimension.

Why this rating - Absence of the classical faculty signals (mentor-models, living curriculum, professional formation in classical pedagogy) yields NOT CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials do not show explicit parent-partnership language such as “parents as co-teachers,” parent formation programs, or active, ongoing parent involvement beyond enrollment. The available content emphasizes inquiry for enrollment and faith-based messaging rather than a formal parent formation or community-education program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: None clearly aligned with classical-parent community signals (e.g., parent formation, book clubs, liturgical year involvement). The visible messaging focuses on enrollment and faith rather than co-teaching or parent formation. - Negative keywords present: None explicitly, but the absence of parent-engagement keywords signals NOT CLASSICAL for this dimension.

Why this rating - Without explicit evidence of parent collaboration, formation, or open-campus parent engagement (as described in the Six Essential Elements), this category is NOT CLASSICAL.

Overall assessment and aggregate ranking - Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL

Aggregate: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

To shift Judah Christian Academy toward a fully CLASSICAL profile, concrete, tangible steps aligned with the classical framework should be undertaken and publicly documented:

- Curriculum transformation
- Adopt and publicly articulate a liberal-arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across appropriate grade bands, including a planned sequence of reading lists (Great Books), primary sources, and a Western-civilization/history emphasis that treats history as a continuous thread rather than “social studies.”
- Introduce Great Books program and reference the Great Conversation in admissions and curriculum guides; include explicit language in the mission and program pages.
- Consider classical languages (Latin or Greek) as an option for upper elementary or middle school with a clear rationale and progression.
- Pedagogy upgrades
- Embed Socratic dialogue, seminars, and debate in upper grades; document the pedagogical approach and provide teacher training resources on classical methods.
- Implement scholé-inspired restful learning days or cycles to balance rigorous inquiry with contemplation and wonder.
- Incorporate memory work, recitation, and potentially liturgical music or chant in appropriate grade levels as a conscious method of fostering memory and reverence for truth, goodness, and beauty.

- Faculty development and portrait
- Develop a “living curriculum” framework and a formal “portrait of a teacher” that positions faculty as mentors and guides in the classical sense (sages, exemplars, and co-learners with students).
- Provide ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy, including opportunities to engage with classical education resources and fellow teachers.
- Parental engagement and community
- Create formal parent-formation programs (book studies, lectures, and book clubs) focused on classical education, paideia, and the Great Conversation.
- Position parents as co-teachers by inviting them into seminars, readings, and school events; open campus visits and curated parent nights to discuss classical education philosophy and practices.
- Explicit alignment and branding
- Update mission and communications to explicitly reference classical education terms (truth, goodness, beauty; liberal arts; paideia; Great Books; scholé).
- Develop and publish a short, public document outlining a classical education plan, with milestones for grades K–12 and a timeline for implementation.

These needle-moving steps align with the Positive Keyword framework and the Six Essential Elements’ emphasis on liberty, formation, and Great Books-centric pedagogy. The classicality lexicon underscores essential elements such as truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, dialogic pedagogy, Great Books, and the Great Conversation; public-facing adoption of these elements would move the school toward CLASSICAL status rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. See the lexicon and its guidance for aligning with the classical framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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